

HOUSE No. 217

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

David F. DeCoste and Jeffrey Rosario Turco

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to ensuring resources and support for pregnant and parenting families.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>David F. DeCoste</i>	<i>5th Plymouth</i>	<i>1/17/2025</i>
<i>Joseph D. McKenna</i>	<i>18th Worcester</i>	<i>3/2/2025</i>
<i>Colleen M. Garry</i>	<i>36th Middlesex</i>	<i>3/2/2025</i>
<i>John R. Gaskey</i>	<i>2nd Plymouth</i>	<i>3/12/2025</i>
<i>John J. Marsi</i>	<i>6th Worcester</i>	<i>8/19/2025</i>
<i>Patrick Joseph Kearney</i>	<i>4th Plymouth</i>	<i>10/22/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 217

By Representatives DeCoste of Norwell and Turco of Winthrop, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 217) of David F. DeCoste, Joseph D. McKenna and Colleen M. Garry relative to providing resources and support for pregnant and parenting families. Children, Families and Persons with Disabilities.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to ensuring resources and support for pregnant and parenting families.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1: Chapter 111 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022 Official Edition,
2 is hereby amended by adding the following section:- Section 51B ½. (a) For the purposes of this
3 section, the following terms shall have the following meanings: “Pregnancy and Parenting
4 Resources”, services provided by any organization, such as a non-profit pregnancy support
5 center, community centers, homeless shelters, churches, or pregnancy medical centers, that: (1)
6 supports expectant mothers in promoting pregnancy equality; and (2) offers resources and
7 services to mothers, fathers, and families, including but not limited to, relationship counseling,
8 ultrasounds, options counseling and support, prenatal and pregnancy education, pregnancy
9 testing, diapers, baby clothes, or material supports. ”Government Resources”, any government or
10 non-government website, advertisement on billboards, buses, trains, garbage cans, television
11 commercials, and social media platforms, that either encourage or dissuade pregnant women
12 from seeking pregnancy and parenting resources. (b) All state agencies shall provide accurate

13 and unbiased information about pregnancy and parenting resources available to families,
14 including, but not limited to, food assistance and breastfeeding support, parenting support and
15 educational assistance, home-based services, financial assistance for childcare, tangible items to
16 assist with parenting, counseling, and other essential needed resources. (c) Official governmental
17 resources shall provide information about available resources and facilities or non-profits that
18 provide pregnancy and parenting resources. Official governmental resources shall not be used to
19 discourage women from seeking pregnancy and parenting resources, food assistance &
20 breastfeeding support, parenting support and educational assistance, home-based services,
21 financial assistance for childcare, tangible items to assist with parenting, and counseling, among
22 others. (d) All state agencies shall cease any efforts to dissuade women from accessing support
23 from government or non-governmental entities or non-profits that provide resources to pregnant
24 or parenting families. Any state agency, including the department of public health, that deals
25 with the well-being of pregnant shall equally promote all facilities serving the needs of pregnant
26 mothers, including, but not limited to, licensed medical facilities and pregnancy resource centers.
27 All state laws or department regulations in conflict with this bill shall be unenforceable under
28 state law.

29 Nothing within this bill shall be construed to prevent any non-profit pregnancy support
30 center, community center, homeless shelter, church, or pregnancy medical center from filing
31 injunctions in the appropriate venue to enforce any section of this bill. SECTION 2. Subsections
32 (a) – (c) shall take effect 90 days after the passage of this act. SECTION 3. Subsection (d) of this
33 section shall take effect immediately upon passage of this act.